GUIDE · FRANCE -> UAE

The real price of a French *perfume in Dubai.*

The same bottle on two shelves, priced in October 2026, and the cascade that explains the gap, line by line.

Zacharie Courie | CEO, Scena Growth

PRICES CHECKED ON 16 OCTOBER 2026

+9 to +26%

more in Dubai than in Paris, taxes included, for the same bottle

Five French niche perfumes compared, same reference and same size, from the brand or its authorised retailers.

Sources: brand websites, Sephora France, Ounass, Faces, Bloomingdale's UAE; ECB exchange rate of 15/10/2026 (AED 4.116 to 1 €)

THE PRICES

Paris
then Dubai.

01 **Juliette Has A Gun, Not a Perfume 100 ml**
140 € in Paris · AED 629 to 680 in Dubai (+9% to +18%)

02 **Diptyque, Do Son 75 ml**
180 € · AED 900 (+21%)

03 **Ex Nihilo, Fleur Narcotique 100 ml**
280 € · AED 1,340 (+16%)

04 **Maison Francis Kurkdjian, Baccarat Rouge 540 70 ml**
255 € · AED 1,320 (+26%)

05 **Initio, Oud for Greatness 90 ml**
320 € · AED 1,620 (+23%)

THE CASCADE · STEPS 1 TO 4

From the factory *to the warehouse.*

01 **Goods: AED 164.64**

40 € ex-works × 4.116. Plausible for a perfume selling at about 140 € in France.

02 **CIF value: AED 174.64**

+ AED 10 of air freight and insurance per bottle (assumption).

03 **Customs duty: AED 8.73**

5% of the CIF value.

04 **Landed cost: AED 189.37**

+ AED 6 of clearance and storage (assumption).

THE CASCADE · STEPS 5 TO 7

From the warehouse *to the shelf.*

01 **Wholesale price: AED 315.62**

Distributor margin: 40% (observed range: 30 to 50%).

02 **Retail price excl. VAT: AED 631.24**

Retailer margin: 50% (observed range: 40 to 60%).

03 **Retail price incl. VAT: AED 662.80**

5% VAT. On shelf, Not a Perfume sells for AED 629 to 680.

01

CUSTOMS

5% of the CIF value, *not the factory price.*

Duty is calculated on the goods plus freight and insurance to the port of arrival, under the Gulf common customs rule. This is the general rate; the main exceptions are alcohol and tobacco.

02

REGISTRATION

No sales *before Montaji.*

In Dubai, no perfume can be imported, advertised or sold without registration in Montaji (Dubai Municipality): ingredient list with allergens, free sale certificate from the country of origin, filed by a local licence holder.

03

TRANSPORT

Perfume travels as *dangerous goods.*

By air, perfume is a flammable liquid (UN1266, class 3).
Observed freight from Europe to Dubai: 1.10 to 1.80 € per kg
depending on volume, plus a dangerous goods surcharge and
a minimum per shipment. Small shipments: cost per bottle climbs fast.

THE 5 MISTAKES

What derails *the price.*

01 **Starting from the factory**

Set the target shelf price first.

02 **Forgetting that margins stack up**

Distributor and retailer margins multiply.

03 **Ignoring marketing support**

Retailers often ask for 15 to 25% of the order as support.

04 **Underestimating registration**

Lead times, cost per SKU, English/Arabic label.

05 **Exclusivity too early**

A wide territory before any proof of sales.

YOUR CASE

Run the numbers *for your brand.*

In a meeting: your landed price, your positioning against the shelf prices, compliance and the points of sale to target.

And the operations: import, storage and shipping by SCENA, with our network of partner distributors.

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